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[Listing Agent Name]

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NEXA Lending

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FOR HOMEOWNERS WHO ARE SELLING AND MOVING

Know Before You Go

Find out what you can qualify for **before** you list, before you pack, and before you sign anything. It takes about five minutes and it's free.

- 5-minute prequal check
- City-to-city comparison
- Seller checklists



Your move, in the right order

Prequalify	Inspect	Fix	List	Pack	Move
Know your number	Find surprises early	Repairs, liens, payoff	Go on the MLS ready	Line up the new home	Close and get the keys

The interactive tools (prequalification check and area comparison) work on the live page: **https://jbarnes1960.github.io/know-before-you-go/**. Worksheets below can be filled in by hand.

WHY NOW

Don't list first and find out later

Selling your home is the easy part. The surprise usually comes when it's time to buy the next one. Many sellers list, get an offer, and only then learn they can't get the new mortgage they assumed

they could, or that their sale nets less than they planned. Then the move is on a clock and the options are thin. Here's what we check for, and why sooner is better:

Credit issues

A late payment, a high card balance, or an old collection can change which loan programs you can use and what they cost. Some of it can be fixed, but it takes time you won't have once you're under contract.

Income changes

A new job, less overtime, retirement, or going self-employed changes how a lender counts your income. Better to hear that now than during underwriting.

Higher costs in the new area

Property taxes, insurance, HOA dues, and flood or wind coverage can be very different from where you live today, and they all count toward your qualifying payment.

Unexpected liens

A judgment, an unpaid tax bill, past-due HOA dues, or a contractor's (mechanic's) lien can show up when the title company searches your home's records. Any of these can delay your closing or stop the sale until they're paid or cleared. Finding them early gives you time to sort them out.

Ask your title company for a preliminary title search before you list.

A higher payoff than you expect

What you owe on your mortgage, HELOC, or second loan is often more than the balance on your statement. Interest adds up daily, and there can be fees, an escrow shortage, or a prepayment charge. That means less cash from your sale for your next down payment.

Request a written payoff statement early, so your net proceeds and down payment are real numbers.

Problems you don't know about yet

A pre-listing home inspection finds issues before a buyer's inspector does, while you still have time to get repairs scheduled and done. See below.



Consider a pre-listing home inspection

An inspection before you go on the MLS shows you what a buyer's inspector will find, while you still control the timeline. Repairs, and especially insurance claims, take weeks to line up.

- **Hail or storm damage to the roof.** It may be covered by insurance, but a claim means an adjuster visit, an estimate, and then a roofer's schedule.
- **Foundation movement or cracks.** An engineer's report and repair plan can take time, and buyers and lenders will want to see them.
- **Anything that may need an insurance claim** (water leaks, storm damage). Call your insurance company first, and give the claim time to work.
- **Fewer surprises later.** Fixing items up front helps you avoid a last-minute price cut or repair request after the buyer's inspection.

What checking first gives you

- **A real price range** for your next home, so you shop and list with confidence.
- **Real numbers from your sale:** an actual payoff and net proceeds, not a guess.
- **No rushed decisions** and fewer deals falling apart late.
- **Time to fix things** (pay down a card, correct a credit report error, clear a lien, schedule repairs) before they become deadlines.
- **Better timing choices**, such as whether to sell first, buy first, or ask for a longer closing or a rent-back.

Checking with a loan officer does not commit you to anything. Your listing agent and I work together so your sale and your purchase fit. A home inspection, title search, and payoff statement come from your inspector, title company, and lender; your listing agent can recommend people to call.

TOOL 1

Quick prequalification check

Enter your numbers and see your debt-to-income ratios and the loan programs you would *likely* fit. Everything is calculated in your browser. Nothing is sent until you press "Send my results to James."

Conventional
Fannie Mae / Freddie Mac, as little as 3% down

FHA
Flexible credit, 3.5% down

VA
For eligible veterans, 0% down

USDA
Eligible rural areas, 0% down

Gross monthly income (before taxes) all borrowers, $

Credit score range your best estimate

Choose…

Monthly debts that show on your credit report (do not include your current housing payment if it will be paid off at closing)

Car payments

Student loans

Credit card minimums

Other debts (child support, personal loans…)

The home you're moving to

Target purchase price, $

Down payment available, $ (e.g. from your sale)

Where (city, state)

Your estimated monthly housing payment is needed to figure the ratios. Either type the total, or let the tool add it up from the pieces. **I don't supply a rate:** use one from a quote or a loan estimate, and the city comparison below can fill in a property tax rate for the new area.

Option A: total new monthly housing payment, $
(principal, interest, taxes, insurance, HOA)

Or use Option B below. If you fill Option A, it's used.

Option B: interest rate % from a quote

Term

30 years

Property tax rate % per year

Home insurance, $ per year

HOA, $ per month

Mortgage insurance, $ per month (if quoted)

A few things that change the answer

- [ ] I or my spouse served in the military (VA loan may be possible)
- [ ] Late payments or collections in the last 12 months
- [ ] Bankruptcy, foreclosure, or short sale in the last 7 years
- [ ] My income changed, or will change, in the last 2 years (new job, self-employed, retiring, less overtime)
- [ ] The new home is in a rural area

Show my ratios and likely programs

TOOL 2

⇄ Where you live now vs. where you're going

On the live page (jbarnes1960.github.io/know-before-you-go), type your current city and your new city to see a side-by-side comparison of home values, rent, household income, property taxes, state income tax, sales tax, and cost of living for about 6,700 U.S. cities and towns, using U.S. Census Bureau, BEA, and Tax Foundation data. Or fill in this worksheet by hand:

	Now	Moving to	Difference
City, state			
Typical home value			
Typical rent			
Property tax rate / yearly tax			
State income tax			
Sales tax			
Cost of living (US = 100)			
Home insurance, HOA, utilities			

Your notes (schools, commute, insurance quotes, anything else you want to remember)

Sources: Home value, rent, household income, population, and property taxes paid: U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey 2020–2024 5-year estimates (tables B25077, B25064, B19013, B01003, B25103), medians for each city or town of about 5,000+ people. Effective property tax rate = median real estate taxes paid ÷ median home value, a rough estimate; your actual bill depends on the appraisal, local rates, and exemptions. Cost of living: U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis, Regional Price Parities 2024 (released Feb. 2026), by metro area; towns outside a metro area use their state's non-metro figure. State income tax: Tax Foundation, top marginal rate on wages as of Jan. 1, 2026 (local income taxes not included). Sales tax: Tax Foundation, state plus average local rate as of July 1, 2026 (state-wide average; the rate in a given city may differ). "n/a" means the source has no figure for that place.

CHECKLIST 1

What a lender will ask for

Start collecting these now. Requirements vary by loan program, and your loan officer may ask for more.

- [ ] Photo ID and Social Security number
- [ ] Last 30 days of pay stubs
- [ ] W-2s for the last 2 years
- [ ] Federal tax returns for the last 2 years (all pages)
- [ ] Self-employed: year-to-date profit and loss, business returns if applicable
- [ ] Last 2 months of bank statements (all pages, all accounts)
- [ ] Retirement and investment account statements
- [ ] Explanation letters for large deposits, gaps in employment, or credit issues
- [ ] Gift letter and donor statements, if family is helping
- [ ] Divorce decree or child support documents, if they apply
- [ ] Veterans: Certificate of Eligibility (James can request it)
- [ ] Signed listing agreement and your sale contract (shows cash from your sale)
- [ ] Current mortgage statement, plus a written payoff statement for every loan on the home (mortgage, HELOC, second lien)
- [ ] Preliminary title report from the title company, showing any liens to clear
- [ ] Homeowners insurance quote for the new home

CHECKLIST 2

Moving checklist

Before you list

- [ ] Run the prequalification check above and talk to James
- [ ] Pull your credit reports (annualcreditreport.com) and fix errors
- [ ] Request a mortgage payoff statement (and one for any HELOC or second loan)
- [ ] Get a net sheet from your listing agent, using the real payoff
- [ ] Ask your title company to run a preliminary title search for liens
- [ ] Order a pre-listing home inspection
- [ ] Schedule repairs; call your insurance company first if it could be a claim (hail, storm, foundation, water)
- [ ] Decide your timing: sell first, buy first, or a rent-back
- [ ] Declutter, repair, and schedule photos

While under contract

- [ ] Keep jobs, cards, and bank accounts steady. No new debt.
- [ ] Send lender documents the same day they're requested
- [ ] Book movers and get quotes
- [ ] Set up insurance for the new home

Final 2 weeks

- [ ] Change your address (USPS, banks, DMV, subscriptions)
- [ ] Transfer or schedule utilities at both homes
- [ ] Update school and medical records
- [ ] Pack an essentials box and keep key papers with you
- [ ] Plan for your closing funds (cashier's check or wire, verified by phone)

Move day

- [ ] Final walkthrough at the new home
- [ ] Photograph meters, and hand over all keys and openers
- [ ] Confirm your closing time with the title company

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